CYBER SAFETY GUY

TIKTOK

THE BASICS PARENTS NEED TO KNOW

TikTok is a short-form video platform where kids watch, create and share videos, follow trends and connect with a global community.

Here's what parents need to know.

1 BILLION+ monthly active TikTok users worldwide — DataReportal (2024)

67% of teens (13–17) use TikTok — Pew Research (2023)

95 MINUTES average time teens spend on TikTok daily — DataReportal (2024)

TOP 3 app teens say they use most often — Pew Research (2023)

WHAT KIDS DO ON TIKTOK

FOR YOU FEED
Endless videos personalised by TikTok's algorithm.

DISCOVER & TRENDS
Find and join trending sounds, challenges and viral content.

CREATE & SHARE
Record, edit and share short videos with music, effects and captions.

LIVE
Go live to interact with viewers in real time.

FOLLOW & CONNECT
Follow creators and friends. Like, comment, share and duet.

INBOX
Message friends or others (based on settings).

WHY KIDS LOVE TIKTOK

- It's fun, creative and entertaining.
- Easy way to discover new interests and talent.
- Helps them connect and feel part of a community.
- The algorithm shows content they love.
- Anyone can go viral and be seen.

RISKS PARENTS SHOULD KNOW

- Inappropriate content can appear in the feed.
- Strangers can contact your child through comments, DMs or Live.
- Overuse can affect sleep, mood and self-esteem.
- Trends and challenges can be risky or harmful.
- Sharing personal info can lead to privacy risks.
- Scams, fake accounts and links can target teens.

TIKTOK PRIVACY: WHAT PARENTS CAN CONTROL

Private Account
Only approved followers can see videos, follow and message.

Who Can Send Messages
Choose "Friends" or "No one".

Comments
Control who can comment on videos ("Everyone", "Friends" or "No one").

Duet & Stitch
Choose who can duet or stitch your child's videos.

Screen Time
Set daily screen time limits and manage notifications.

Restricted Mode
Limit potentially inappropriate content.

Go to: Profile > ☰ > Settings and privacy > Privacy

TIPS TO HELP YOUR CHILD STAY SAFE

- Talk about what they watch, share and post.
- Encourage them to think before they post.
- Set boundaries for screen time.
- Don't share personal info (school, location, phone number, etc.).
- Report and block anything that feels wrong.
- Encourage breaks and offline activities.
- Keep the conversation open and stay involved.

CONVERSATION STARTERS

- What kind of videos do you like to watch on TikTok?
- Who are your favourite creators and why?
- Have you ever seen something that made you uncomfortable?
- Do you know anyone you've talked to online?
- What would you do if someone asked for personal info?
- What trends or challenges are popular right now?

RED FLAGS TO WATCH FOR

- Sudden secrecy about TikTok use.
- Spending much more time on TikTok.
- Getting upset after going online.
- Following or talking to unknown people.
- Sharing personal info or location.
- Drastic mood changes or loss of interest in other activities.

QUICK DO'S & DON'TS

DO
- Encourage open conversations.
- Know who they follow.
- Review privacy settings together.
- Praise good choices.
- Be a trusted place for help.

DON'T
- Spy or snoop.
- Overreact—listen first.
- Dismiss their concerns.
- Ignore red flags.
- Blame or judge.

WHERE TO GET HELP

Childline
0800 1111
childline.org.uk

The Mix
0808 808 4994
themix.org.uk

Internet Matters
internetmatters.org
Advice, guides and tools for parents

REMEMBER

Your involvement today helps your child make safer choices tomorrow.

NEED TO TALK? CHILDLINE | **0800 1111** childline.org.uk | **YOU ARE NOT ALONE** We're here for you.